



Odin forced Loki to return to human form by squeezing his salmon tail, then dropped him on the ground. The rest of the Aesir closed in as Loki spat up water from his lungs.

“Listen, don’t act hastily and do something you’ll regret,” he said. “Can’t we talk about this like civilized gods?”

“Civilized?” Frigg said, her face white with rage. “Was it civilized to kill my beloved son?”

“That wasn’t me!” Loki cried, sounding aggrieved. “Hodr shot that arrow – you all saw.”

*“We saw you give Hodr the arrow and then guide his aim,” Odin said. “You have done many evil things in your life, Loki, and have gone unpunished. Not this time.”*

“I’m not the only evil-doer here, Odin,” Loki snapped as Thor and Heimdall grabbed his arms. “Please!”

The Aesir dragged Loki to a damp cave and chained him so tightly to a rock that he couldn’t move and was forced to stare up at the roof. “It’s a bit uncomfortable, I suppose,” Loki muttered, “but it could be worse.”